MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

BBA (HONOURS) THIRD SEMESTER

EXAMINATION (2024 ADMISION ONWARDS)

MG3CCRBBA202 – Business Research

Duration: 2 hrs Maximum Marks: 70

Students should attempt atleast one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

Short answer (four to five sentences)

A choice between two options for each question, answer five short answers questions, one from each pair

1a. Explain the meaning of research and how it differs from casual inquiry or everyday information gathering. CO1(U)

OR

1b. Summarize the key reasons why it is important for contemporary researchers to study the history of research methodology. CO1(U)

2a. Why descriptive research is often referred to as ex post facto research in social science and business studies. CO1 (U)

OR

2b. Explain two examples of ethical and two examples of unethical research practices. CO1 (U)

3a. Apply any one type of measurement scale to classify the following research data: CO3 (A)

1. Gender of respondents
2. Level of satisfaction (Very Satisfied to Very Dissatisfied)
3. Annual income in rupees

OR

3b. A researcher is conducting a study on college students' internet usage habits across multiple campuses. Apply the steps in sample design to outline how the researcher should plan the sampling process. CO3 (A)

4a. Explain the difference between independent and dependent variables with suitable research examples. CO3(U)

OR

4b. Describe the four levels of measurement scales and how they differ in terms of data classification. CO3(U)

5a. Describe what is meant by coding of data and why it is an important step before data analysis. CO4(U)

OR

5b. Describe the key differences between APA and MLA referencing styles in terms of citation format. CO4 (U)

5*3=15

Part B

Short Essay

A choice between two options for each question, answer three short essay questions, one from each pair

6a. Differentiate between fundamental research and applied research, and explain with one example for each. CO1(U)

OR

6b. Classify the following activities as either basic or applied research, and justify your answer in each case: CO1(U)

1. Reading blogs to understand why people procrastinate
2. Developing a mobile app to track user study patterns
3. Observing birds to identify their feeding behavior

7a. Describe the process of editing and coding in research data handling. Why are these steps essential for ensuring the accuracy and usability of data? CO4 (U)

OR

7b. List and explain the different types of research reports and their suitable applications in academic or organizational contexts. CO4 (U)

8a. You are reviewing a peer's research report draft and find that it lacks an executive summary and proper chapterization. Apply your understanding of report mechanics to suggest improvements and explain why these elements are important. CO4 (A)

OR

8b. You are preparing the bibliography section for your final report using APA style. Apply your knowledge of referencing styles by converting the following reference into correct APA format: Sharma, R. (2022). Digital Marketing Trends. New Delhi: Pearson Education. CO4 (A)

3*5=15

Part C

Long Essay

A choice between two options for each question, answer two long essay questions, one from each pair

9a. Explain the concept of a hypothesis in research. Discuss the characteristics of a good hypothesis, and outline the basic concepts and steps involved in hypothesis testing, with relevant examples.CO2(U)

OR

9b. You are required to explain the early stages of a research process using the topic "The Impact of Social Media Usage on Academic Performance among College Students." This includes identifying the research problem, framing a problem statement, formulating research questions and objectives, selecting an appropriate research design with justification, and explaining the role of a literature review. CO2(U)

10a.Differentiate between primary and secondary data with examples. Explain the strengths and limitations of each and describe appropriate situations where each should be used. CO3(U)

OR

10b. "Explain the steps involved in sample design. Describe the criteria for selecting a suitable sampling procedure for a hypothetical research problem, and highlight the characteristics of a good sample design." CO3(U)

2*20=40